

Promises and Pressure: Consequences

承诺与压力：后果

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The consequences were **emotional** and, at the **core**, simple. The **last question** in the survey asked what a family is for, and the answers exposed a **vacuum** where a definition should have been. A **prince**, a **princess**, and a **philosopher** gave the same reply: for holding what cannot be held anywhere else.

The **appearance** of a stranger at the door changed the morning. A **porter**, a **waiter**, and a **fireman** came to the **residence** to repair the **rail**; a **hunter** in a **blue** coat brought a **rabbit** for the **infant** next door. “**Anybody** could have done it,” the **tailor** said. “Nobody did.”

The **intention** of the **donor** was good, and the **delivery** was terrible. They received a **melon**, a **vacuum** cleaner, and a **bench** with a **mysterious** inscription from an **ancestor** of the family of the **butcher**. A second parcel arrived for him the same afternoon, addressed to the wrong man and opened by everyone. “They will **dismiss** it as charming,” Maya said. “That is the **exception**, not the rule.”

He was away when the **kiss** happened, and he had to hear of it from her. “You will say I am like the man in the old story,” she said, “and I am not sure that I am not.” The **chilly** answer was that the **germ** of the quarrel had been there since the first week, and he had to be sure of that before he could say it aloud.

Dad was **living** in a small flat around the corner, and it had taken real **talent** to be so ordinary. The **imaginative descendant** of a **blond Homo sapiens** and a **diligent tailor** wrote a **parade** of small substitutions: a **bench** for a bed, a **rabbit** for a **rabbit**, a **question** for a **question**. The **hatred** between the two families had not disappeared; it had simply gone back to being what it had been at the beginning — a habit they could lose. The **tailor** had mended the same coat three times, and the **butcher** had sold him the same cut of meat for twenty years; neither of them had ever said the word **hatred** aloud, and that silence, too, was a kind of inheritance.

中文翻译

后果是情感性的，而核心很简单。调查的最后一个问题问的是：家庭是为了什么？答案暴露出一个本应放着定义的空洞。一位王子、一位公主和一位哲学家给出了同样的回答：为了承载别处无法承载的东西。

门口一个陌生人的出现改变了这个早晨。一位门房、一位侍者和一名消防员来到住处修理栏杆；一位穿蓝色外套的猎人给隔壁的婴儿带来了一只兔子。“任何人都能做到，”裁缝说，“可没有人做。”

捐赠者的意图是好的，交付却很糟糕。他们收到了一只甜瓜、一台吸尘器，以及一条长椅，上面刻着屠夫家一位祖先留下的神秘铭文。同一天下午，又有一个包裹寄给他，收件人写错了，被所有人拆开看了。“他们会把它当作可爱的东西打发掉，”曼雅说，“那是例外，不是常规。”

那个吻发生的时候他不在场，只能听她说。“你会说我就是老故事里的那个男人，”她说，“而我也不确定我不是。”冷淡的回答是：这场争吵的细菌从第一周起就已经在那里了；而在他能把这句话说出口之前，他必须先对这一点确信无疑。

爸爸住在街角一间小公寓里，而要把日子过得如此普通，其实需要真正的才能。一个金发的智人与一位勤勉裁缝的富有想象力的后裔，写下了一连串小小的替代：用长椅替代床、用兔子替代兔子、用问题替代问题。两个家庭之间的仇恨并没有消失；它只是又变回了它一开始的样子——一种他们可以丢掉的习惯。那位裁缝把同一件外套补过三次，那位屠夫二十年来卖给他同一块肉；他们两人谁也没有把“仇恨”这个词说出口，而那份沉默，同样是一种遗产。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
last lɑːst POS: a	a. 最后的, 末尾的, 最近的; vi. 持续, 支持, 维持; vt. 使维持, 够...用; adv. 最后, 后来; n. 最后, 末尾, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the last or lowest in an ordering or series; n. a person's dying act; the final thing a person can do; n. a...
question 'kwestʃən POS: n	n. 问题, 询问; v. 询问, 审问, 怀疑; [计] 询问 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an instance of questioning; n. the subject matter at issue; n. a sentence of inquiry that asks for a reply; n...
blue bluː POS: n	n. 蓝色; a. 蓝色的, 下流的, 忧郁的; vt. 染成蓝色; vi. 变蓝 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. blue color or pigment; resembling the color of the clear sky in the daytime; n. blue clothing; n. any organi...
dad dæd POS: n	n. 爸爸, 爹爹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an informal term for a father; probably derived from baby talk
living 'liviŋ POS: n	n. 生活, 生计, 生存; a. 活的, 逼真的, 现存的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people who are still living; a. pertaining to living persons; s. true to life; lifelike; s. (informal) absolu...
anybody 'eniɒdi POS: pron	pron. 任何人; n. 重要人物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Any one out of an indefinite number of persons; anyone; any person.; n. A person of consideration or sta...
appearance ə'piərəns POS: n	n. 出现, 露面, 外观, 外表, 出版; [计] 外观, 版面 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. outward or visible aspect of a person or thing; n. the event of coming into sight; n. formal attendance (in...
prince prɪns POS: n	n. 王子, 亲王, 国君, 贵族, 诸侯, 有权势的大人物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a male member of a royal family other than the sovereign (especially the son of a sovereign)
intention in'tenʃən POS: n	n. 意图, 目的, 含义; [医] 愈合, 意向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) the goal with respect to a marriage proposal; n. an act of intending; a volition that you...
emotional i'məʊʃənəl POS: a	a. 情绪的, 情感的; [医] 情绪的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. determined or actuated by emotion rather than reason; a. of more than usual emotion; a. of or pertaining to...
core kɔː POS: n	n. 核心, 果心, 要点; vt. 挖...的核; [计] 内核, 核心网 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small group of indispensable persons or things; n. the center of an object; n. the central part of the Ear...
rail reɪl POS: n	n. 横杆, 围栏, 栏杆, 铁轨, 扶手, 秧鸡; vt. 以横木围栏, 给...铺铁轨; vi. 责骂, 抱怨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. short for railway; n. a horizontal bar (usually of wood or metal); n. any of numerous widely distributed sma...
expose ik'spəʊz POS: vt	vt. 使暴露, 使曝光, 揭穿, 陈列; [医] 暴露, 露置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the exposure of an impostor or a fraud; v. expose or make accessible to some action or influence; v. to show...
talent 'tælənt POS: n	n. 天才, 才能, 有才干的人, 天资 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who possesses unusual innate ability in some field or activity
exception ik'sɛpʃən POS: n	n. 例外, 除外, 异议; [计] 例外; 异常 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a deliberate act of omission; n. an instance that does not conform to a rule or generalization; the only ex...
dismiss dis'mɪs POS: vt	vt. 解散, 开除, 解职; vi. 解散; [计] 解散 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bar from attention or consideration; v. cease to consider; put out of judicial consideration; v. stop associ...
delivery di'lɪvəri POS: n	n. 递送, 交付, 分娩, 交货, 引渡; [化] 交货额 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of delivering or distributing something (as goods or mail); n. the event of giving birth; n. the vol...
kiss kɪs POS: n	n. 吻; vt. 吻; vi. 接吻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of caressing with the lips (or an instance thereof); n. a cookie made of egg whites and sugar; n. an...
princess 'prɪnsɪs POS: n	n. 公主, 王妃, 女巨头 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female member of a royal family other than the queen (especially the daughter of a sovereign)
bench bentʃ POS: n	n. 长椅子; [机] 台 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a long seat for more than one person; n. the magistrate or judge or judges sitting in court in judicial cap...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
infant 'ɪnfənt POS: n	n. 婴儿, 儿童, 初学者; a. 婴儿的, 幼稚的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a very young child (birth to 1 year) who has not yet begun to walk or talk
hunter 'hʌntə POS: n	n. 猎人, 猎犬, 追求者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who hunts game; n. a person who searches for something; n. a watch with a hinged metal lid to protec...
rabbit 'ræbɪt POS: n	n. 兔子; vi. 猎兔; vt. 让...见鬼去 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various burrowing animals of the family Leporidae having long ears and short tails; some domesticat...
residence 'rezɪdəns POS: n	n. 住宅, 居留, 驻扎, 居住期间; [医] 住房 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any address at which you dwell more than temporarily; n. the official house or establishment of an importan...
donor 'dəʊnə POS: n	n. 捐赠人; [化] 给体; 供体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. person who makes a gift of property; n. (medicine) someone who gives blood or tissue or an organ to be used...
parade pə'reɪd POS: n	n. 游行, 炫耀, 阅兵; v. 游行, 炫耀, (使) 列队行进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a ceremonial procession including people marching; n. an extended (often showy) succession of persons or th...
mysterious mɪ'stɪəriəs POS: a	a. 神秘的, 难解的, 不可思议的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having an import not apparent to the senses nor obvious to the intelligence; beyond ordinary understanding
ancestor 'ænsəstə POS: n	n. 祖先, 祖宗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone from whom you are descended (but usually more remote than a grandparent)
philosopher fɪ'lɒsəfə POS: n	n. 哲学家, 哲人, 思想开创新人, 达观的人; [法] 哲学家, 哲学研究者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a specialist in philosophy; n. a wise person who is calm and rational; someone who lives a life of reason w...
blond blɒnd POS: a	a. 金发的; n. 白肤碧眼金发的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person with fair skin and hair; n. a light grayish yellow to near white; a. being or having light colored...
vacuum 'vækjuəm POS: n	n. 真空, 空间, 真空吸尘器; a. 真空的, 产生真空的, 利用真空的; vt. 用吸尘器打扫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the absence of matter; n. a region that is devoid of matter; n. an electrical home appliance that cleans by...
hatred 'heitrɪd POS: n	n. 憎恨, 仇恨, 憎恶; [法] 敌意, 憎恨, 憎恶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the emotion of intense dislike; a feeling of dislike so strong that it demands action
waiter 'weɪtə POS: n	n. 侍者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person whose occupation is to serve at table (as in a restaurant); n. a person who waits or awaits
imaginative ɪ'mædʒɪnətɪv POS: a	a. 想像的, 虚构的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (used of persons or artifacts) marked by independence and creativity in thought or action
descendant dɪ'sendənt POS: n	n. 后裔, 子孙; a. 传下的, 下降的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person considered as descended from some ancestor or race; s. going or coming down; s. proceeding by desce...
porter 'pɔ:tə POS: n	n. 大楼管理员, 门房, 搬运工人, 侍者, 服务员; [化] 搬运车; 搬运工人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person employed to carry luggage and supplies; n. United States writer of novels and short stories (1890-...
substitution ˌsʌbstɪ'tju:ʃən POS: n	n. 代替, 替换, 代替物; [计] 置换 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event in which one thing is substituted for another; n. the act of putting one thing or person in the pl...
fireman 'faɪəməŋ POS: n	n. 救火队员, 消防队员; [机] 司炉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. play in which children pretend to put out a fire; n. a member of a fire department who tries to extinguish...
tailor 'teɪlə POS: n	n. 裁缝, 成衣匠; vt. 缝制, 制作, 使适应; vi. 做裁缝 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person whose occupation is making and altering garments; v. adjust to a specific need or market
butcher 'bʊtʃə POS: n	n. 屠夫, 肉商, 小贩; vt. 屠宰, 屠杀 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a retailer of meat; n. a brutal indiscriminate murderer; n. a person who slaughters or dresses meat for mark...
chilly 'tʃɪli POS: a	a. 寒冷的, 冷淡的, 不友好的; [建] 番椒, 冷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. not characterized by emotion; s. appreciably or disagreeably cold; s. lacking warmth of feeling

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
germ dʒə:m POS: n	n. 细菌, 种子, 生殖细胞, 根源; [医] 芽胞, 胚, 胚芽, 病菌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small apparently simple structure (as a fertilized egg) from which new tissue can develop into a complet...
melon 'melən POS: n	n. 瓜, 甜瓜, 红利, 赃物; [化] 三聚二氰亚胺 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of numerous fruits of the gourd family having a hard rind and sweet juicy flesh; n. any of various frui...
diligent 'dɪlɪdʒənt POS: a	a. 勤勉的, 用功的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. quietly and steadily persevering especially in detail or exactness; a. characterized by care and perseveran...
Homo 'həʊməʊ POS: review required	[化] 最高占据轨道: 最高占据分子轨道: 最高已占分子轨道; [医] 人属 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any living or extinct member of the family Hominidae characterized by superior intelligence, articulate sp...